

HOUSE BILL 1444

By Gillespie

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 37
and Title 39, relative to cruelty to animals.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 39-14-212(d), is amended by deleting "Class E felony" and substituting "Class D felony".

SECTION 2. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 37-1-131(g)(2), is amended by adding the following as a new subdivision:

(Q) Aggravated cruelty to animals, as defined in § 39-14-212.

SECTION 3. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 37-1-131(g)(1), is amended by deleting "(g)(2)(C)-(P)" wherever it appears and substituting "(g)(2)(C)-(Q)".

SECTION 4. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 37-1-131(g)(4)(B), is amended by deleting "Class B felony" and substituting "Class B felony or Class D felony".

SECTION 5. This act takes effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it, and applies to acts committed on or after that date.